



TECHNICAL REPORT

# Senso Comune Gallery

Design, commerce and compliance

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*Unique paintings, sold from mainland China to buyers at home and abroad. What follows is what that costs, what it requires, and what is still unresolved.*

Prepared for Priscilla  
Date 2026-09-17  
Repository `senso-comune-gallery`

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## PART 1

# Summary

## 1.1 What this is

A site selling unique paintings — six in the catalogue at the time of writing, priced \$60–\$440 — run by one non-technical person resident in mainland China, addressed equally to international and domestic buyers.

That last sentence contains most of the difficulty. A gallery site for a handful of works is an afternoon's work. A gallery site for a handful of works that takes money across the Chinese border, ships physical objects internationally, satisfies two consumer-law regimes at once and loads acceptably on both sides of the Great Firewall is not.

Nothing in the build is fixed to six. The counts, the series and the page set are all derived from the work data; adding a seventh work, or a new series, is a data edit.

## 1.2 Where things stand

Table 1: The site on 17 September 2026

|                |                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Built          | 36 pages, 18 in each language: the homepage, the catalogue and its two series, six work pages, sold works, and seven pages of information |
| Published      | A <b>preview</b> on GitHub Pages: not indexed, labelled on every page, and unable to take an order                                        |
| Ready to sell  | <b>No.</b> The readiness gate counts 54 details still owed (Section 5.5.4), and a release refuses to build until they are supplied        |
| Checked        | Five checks on every build, and a sixth in a real browser (Section 5.4)                                                                   |
| Still to build | The buy box and disclosures on the work page; the cart, search and account behind the shop bar (Section 6.6)                              |



## 1.3 The seven findings that would have sunk it

Table 2: Blocking findings, all now dealt with in the build

| Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Where       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Every call to action was #A19E97 — <b>2.67:1</b> , failing both the body-text and the large-text floor. No font size rescues it.                                                                         | Section 2.2 |
| <b>Stripe</b> is unavailable to a mainland-China seller — the whole account, not merely PayPal. <b>Airwallex</b> excludes mainland entities from card acquiring and opens no individual accounts at all. | Section 3.1 |
| <code>vercel.app</code> and <code>workers.dev</code> measure <b>100% blocked</b> from mainland China. <code>pages.dev</code> measures 0%.                                                                | Section 1.4 |
| A unique pre-existing painting gets <b>no returns exception</b> under either Chinese or EU law. Uniqueness is not personalisation.                                                                       | Section 4.1 |
| Instagram was the only contact channel. It is blocked in mainland China, and EU law requires an email address regardless.                                                                                | Section 4.2 |
| <b>China-origin paintings are not duty-free into the United States.</b> Section 301 adds 7.5% and the \$800 de minimis exemption is suspended.                                                           | Section 3.3 |
| A one-page site cannot link to one painting, which is the site's main acquisition motion.                                                                                                                | Section 2.7 |

## 1.4 Decisions taken

### Settled

**Launch as an individual**, with the Hong Kong entity reachable as a configuration change rather than a rebuild. Under CNY 100,000 annual turnover there is no business-registration requirement, no foreign-exchange quota consumed, no balance-of-payments filing and no VAT.

**Host on Cloudflare Pages.** The only option with no bill, no pause, no terms problem and no ICP filing.

**A page for everything that is shared.** Every work, series and policy has its own address in both languages; two lines of CSS (@view-transition) keep the calm of a single page when moving between them.

**Self-host the fonts.** 81.7 KB for both families, built from the variable originals.

**Adopt Priscilla's sage palette**, with text moved onto cream.

## 1.5 Cost

Table 3: Running cost of the recommended build

| Item                          | One-off       | Annual      |
|-------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Hosting (Cloudflare Pages)    | \$0           | \$0         |
| Domain (registrar at cost)    | —             | \$11        |
| Fonts, licensing (SIL OFL)    | \$0           | \$0         |
| Analytics                     | \$0           | \$0         |
| Photography, phone build      | \$6–25        | —           |
| Photography, full build       | \$360–400     | —           |
| Copyright registration, batch | \$85          | —           |
| <b>Total, minimum viable</b>  | <b>\$6–25</b> | <b>\$11</b> |

Payment processing is separate and depends on the entity decision; see Section 3.1.

## PART 2

# Design

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## 2.1 Where the design came from

Priscilla supplied a nine-page draft and, later, a live mockup with a revised palette. Both were treated as the brief. The work here was not to redesign but to find where the drawing and the medium disagree — and they disagreed mostly about contrast.

## 2.2 The palette

Priscilla's mockup moves the site from white to a sage-green world: a dark brown mast-head bar, warm brown text, terracotta, and cream plates behind the paintings. Two of her decisions were already right and are kept exactly as drawn — the warm browns, and a **filled** terracotta button.

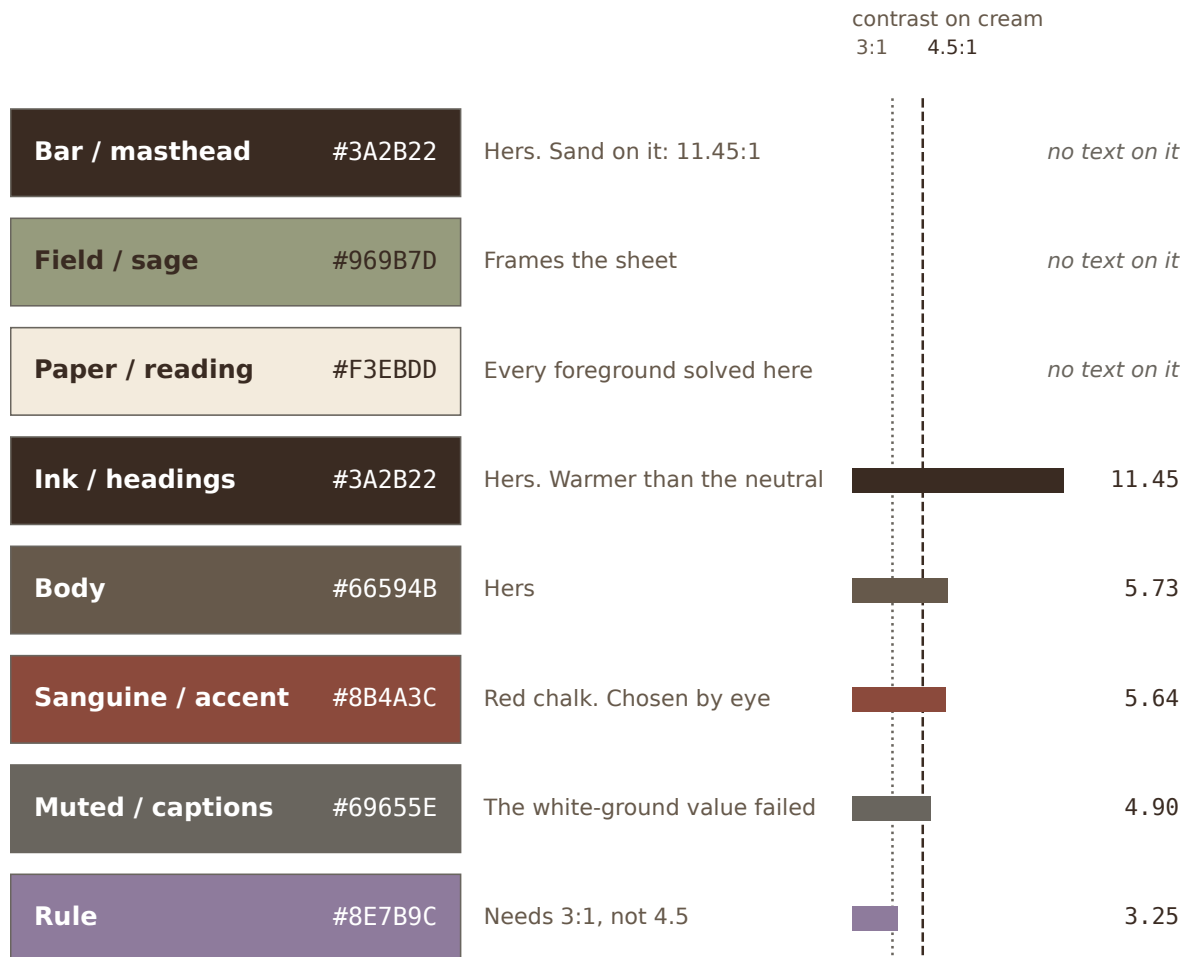


Figure 1: The palette as built. Each value is read from the project's token file, not transcribed.

2.2.1 What could not be adopted as drawn

Body text on the sage does not pass, and the accent on sage is worse than the value it was replacing.

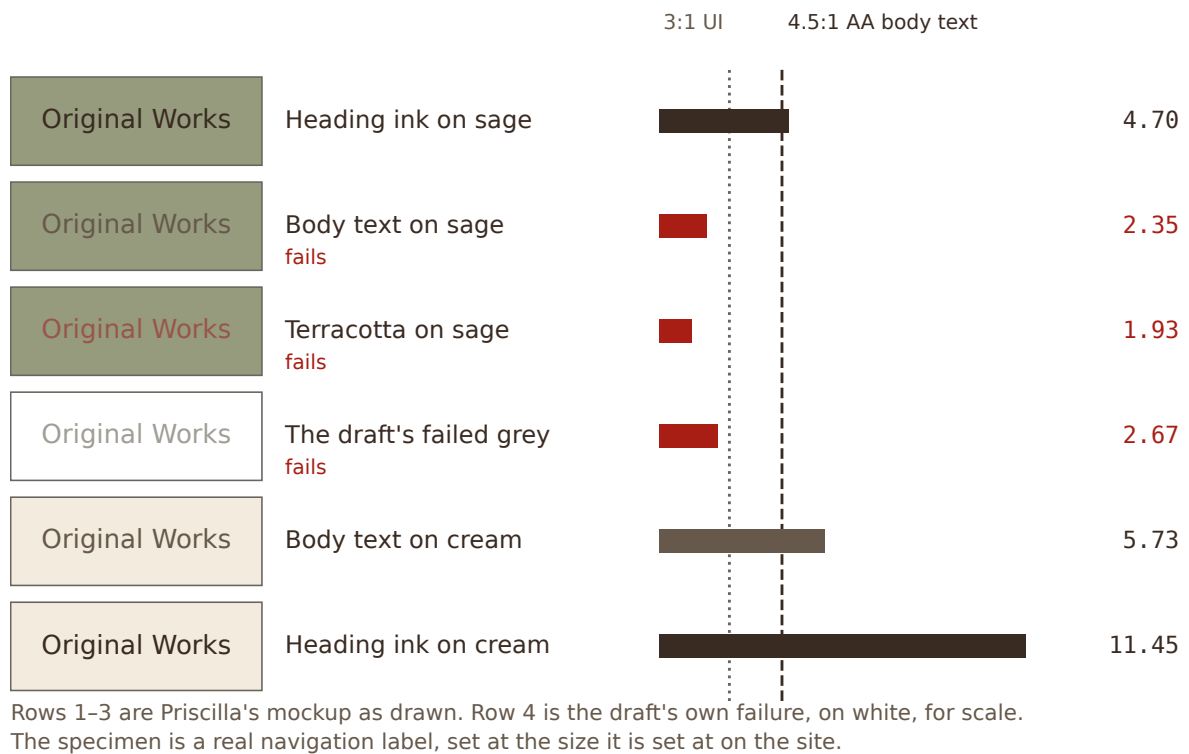


Figure 2: Why the sage carries no text. The three red bars are Priscilla’s mockup as drawn; the draft’s original failure is included for scale.

**The resolution was already in her own mockup**

She sets the paintings on light cream plates against the sage. So sage becomes the **field** and cream the **reading surface** — the whole content column is a cream sheet mounted on sage, which is what a gallery does to a work on paper anyway.

Her green stays dominant at the margins, the reading happens on cream, and nothing sets text on sage.

### 2.2.2 The warm-ground trap

#767676 is the canonical “lightest grey that passes on white”. On pure white it passes at 4.54:1, with 0.04 to spare. Warm the ground at all and it fails.

This caught the project three times — twice in tokens written specifically to avoid it. The response was to stop checking by eye: `scripts/check-contrast.mjs` recomputes every token against **the darkest ground it is ever painted on** and fails the build on a regression.

## 2.3 Typography

Two open-source variable faces, self-hosted: Fraunces and Inter.

Table 4: Font build, measured rather than estimated

| Build                                             | Bytes         |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Fraunces, all four axes                           | 121,124       |
| <b>Fraunces, opsz 14–40, wght 400–700, WONK 1</b> | <b>51,868</b> |
| Fraunces, opsz pinned                             | 32,500        |
| <b>Inter, opsz 18, wght 400–600</b>               | <b>29,856</b> |
| <b>Total, both families, latin subset</b>         | <b>81,724</b> |

Two corrections came out of running the build rather than reading about it. The draft sets Fraunces at six optical sizes — 16.0, 16.8, 21.6, 27.2, 30.4 and 38.4 — so the `opsz` axis must stay live; pinning it saves 19 KB and flattens the optical sizing the design depends on. And Fraunces’ `WONK` axis defaults to **1, not 0**; pinning it to 0 changes the letterforms to save 140 bytes.

### 2.3.1 The scale

Not the golden ratio. The one proportional system in Leonardo’s own hand, on the *Vitruvian Man* sheet, is whole-number fractions of height.

Table 5: Type scale, and how close Priscilla’s draft already was

| Role | Fraction       | Computed | Draft used |
|------|----------------|----------|------------|
| Hero | 1 (the height) | 38.4 px  | 38.4 px    |

| Role            | Fraction  | Computed | Draft used |
|-----------------|-----------|----------|------------|
| Section heading | less 1/8  | 33.6 px  | 30.4 px    |
| Sub-heading     | less 1/4  | 28.8 px  | 27.2 px    |
| Wordmark        | 1/6 + 1/4 | 22.4 px  | 21.6 px    |
| Body            | the unit  | 16.8 px  | 16.8 px    |
| Caption         | less 1/4  | 12.6 px  | 13.1 px    |

## 2.4 The mark

The site had a wordmark and no mark. On a business whose entire acquisition motion is a link in an Instagram or a WeChat bio, the surfaces that render most often are a browser tab, a share card and an avatar — and none of them can render a wordmark.

### 2.4.1 The constraint that decides it

The wordmark translates: *Senso Comune Gallery* in English, 常识画廊 in Chinese. That was a deliberate decision and it is the right one — a Chinese buyer should not have to read a Latin name to know where they are.

It also settles the logo. A favicon is chosen by **origin**, not by page: one file serves both URL trees, so a site cannot ship one monogram per locale however much it would like to. Any mark built from letterforms therefore serves one audience and decorates the other. SC is not the initials of 常识画廊.

#### This is why the first icon was replaced

The first icon was SC, cut from real Fraunces outlines. It read at 16 px, and it served only one of the two audiences: the problem is *make something that reads at 16 px in two languages*.

### 2.4.2 The options

Six were drawn. Four of them are eliminated by the same column of Figure 3 — the one that shows each candidate at the size it will actually be rendered at most of the time.

at display size 16 px



### Wordmark alone

WHERE THE SITE STARTED

Nothing to put in a tab. Illegible below about 90 px, and there is no second lockup for a share card or a WeChat avatar.



### SC monogram

WHAT SHIPPED IN SEPTEMBER

Reads at 16 px. But the wordmark translates, and the Chinese one is not spelled with Latin letters at all. It serves one of the two audiences.



### One monogram per locale

THE OBVIOUS REPAIR

Two marks is two brands. The favicon is chosen by the origin, not by the page, so a bilingual site cannot swap it per locale anyway.



### Leonardo's hatching

THE DEBT, MADE LITERAL

Announces the reference the brief asked to be carried quietly, and at 16 px it is four grey lines.



### Sfumato disc

THE PRINCIPLE, MADE LITERAL

A soft edge cannot survive a 32 px ICO, a monochrome fax of an invoice or an embroidered label. It has no outline to fall back to.



### A work on a wall

RECOMMENDED

Carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales. Its proportions are the catalogue's own: a 3:4 portrait hung at 144.78 cm on a 244 cm wall.

Figure 3: Six candidates, each drawn twice: at a size where anyone would approve it, and at 16 px, where it will spend its life.

#### 2.4.3 What was chosen

A work on a wall — the site's own structure, which is a cream sheet mounted on a sage field, reduced to three rectangles. It carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales and it cannot fall back to the wrong typeface.

Nothing in it is arbitrary. Every number is one the project had already committed to somewhere else.



Table 6: The mark, and where each of its numbers comes from

| Element | Value                                                | Source                                                                                                   |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wall    | 64 × 64, <code>--bar</code>                          | The masthead. A piece of the site, not a badge applied to it                                             |
| Plate   | 28 × 37.33 — <b>3:4</b> — <code>--paper</code>       | The modal aspect of the catalogue, every work in which is portrait                                       |
| Datum   | Full width, <code>--field</code> , at <b>59.34</b> % | 144.78 cm on a 244 cm wall — the museum hanging standard the work-page scale diagram is already drawn to |

The datum runs the full width and passes *behind* the plate, so what is visible is two short sage segments either side of the work. That is what a hanging line looks like on a real wall, and it is the detail that stops the mark reading as a generic picture-frame glyph.

#### 2.4.4 Two renderings, one geometry

The wall is a **fill** where it can be seen and an **outline** where it cannot. In the tab, on the home screen and in this document's footer, the wall is painted. On the site's own masthead the ground is already `--bar`, so a filled wall would be no wall at all; there it is drawn as a 1.5-unit sage outline and everything else is identical.

Both are generated from `scripts/mark.mjs`. The report reads the same file — Figure 3 is drawn from it, not from a copy of its numbers — so the document cannot end up arguing for a mark the site no longer ships.

#### 2.4.5 What it deliberately does not do

- **It spends no accent.** Sanguine is 2.03:1 on the bar and would disappear at tab size; the sage datum is 4.70:1. The accent stays reserved for calls to action, which is most of what this palette is for.
- **It depends on no font.** An SVG favicon is rendered *without* the page's webfonts, so a mark set as `<text>` falls back to whatever serif the operating system has. Three rectangles and a line have no such failure mode.
- **It has no per-locale variant**, by construction. Section 2.4.1 is the reason, and the build asserts it: the masthead lockup is byte-identical on the English and Chinese home-pages.

WCAG contrast is defined on relative luminance, so converting the mark to greyscale leaves both of its ratios exactly where they are — 11.45:1 and 4.70:1 — and it survives a monochrome print unchanged. Two cases have **not** been tested: single-ink reproduction, where plate and datum cannot be separated by lightness at all, and embroidery below about 15 mm. Neither is needed before launch.

#### 2.4.6 Where it is used

`icon.svg`, `favicon.ico` at 32 px, `apple-touch-icon.png` at 180 px and `site.webmanifest`, all from one source; the masthead lockup, where the mark and the name are a single link and a single tab stop; and this document, in the footer of every page and on the title page.

Seven assertions in `scripts/check-review.mjs` (F-01 to F-04) hold it together: that the icon is the geometry `mark.mjs` declares, that the masthead draws the same plate, that the mark contributes no accessible name of its own, that it is identical in both locales, that it spends no accent, and that the hanging figure is the one the work pages cite.

## 2.5 Softness

The site as first built was correct and a little hard: square sheet, flat works, a colour swap for a hover and hard stops where sections met. This pass asked for something softer and more elegant — without making it less professional, and without changing a single colour.

Those two constraints do most of the design work. Every familiar softening technique reaches for new colour (a white card, a black shadow, a coloured glow) or for lower contrast (translucency), and this site has already argued, with measurements, against both.

#### 2.5.1 What limits it

Three commitments made earlier in this document bound what “soft” may mean here.

- **Quietness is bought with size and whitespace, never with contrast.** Anything translucent puts text over a ground that is no longer a token, so its contrast has to be measured against the worst thing that can pass beneath it — which, on a site of paintings, is white.
- **Edges dissolve rather than rule** (Section 2.6). A softer site should have *fewer* lines, not decorative new ones.
- **A painting is never altered.** Rounding its corner crops it. Zooming it on hover implies it was cropped to fit. Stretching it misrepresents the object for sale.

Motion has its own limit, already recorded in the stylesheet: many viewport-heights of large images make scroll-triggered movement a vestibular risk, and every animation must stand down when the reader has asked for reduced motion.

### 2.5.2 Research notes

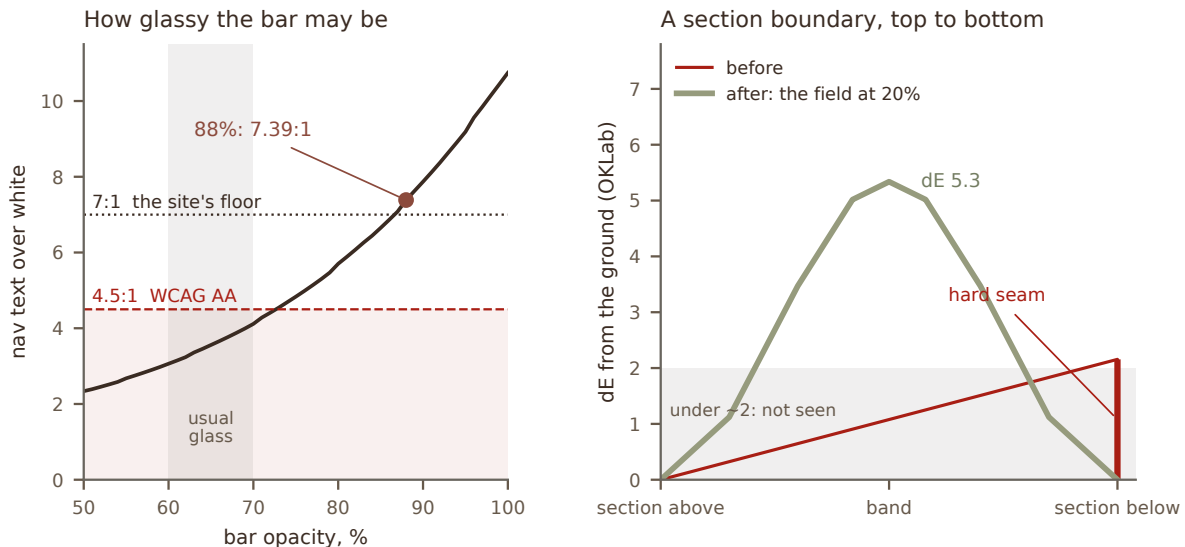


Figure 4: Left: how translucent the masthead may be, measured as navigation text over a white passage of a painting. Right: the lightness of a section boundary from top to bottom, before and after. Both panels are computed from the live token file.

**Glass has a hard floor, and it is high.** The usual glassmorphism panel runs at 60–70% opacity. Over a white passage that puts the navigation at 3.06–4.11:1: a failure at caption size. WCAG's 4.5:1 is reached at 73%; a full AAA margin of 7:1 needs 87%. The glass that is legal here is subtle by necessity, and the right-hand side of Figure 4 is why it is still worth having: a painting passing under a solid bar is cut off by a slab, while under 88% it is *felt* as a soft blur of its own colour.

**Glass at rest would repaint the brand.** Prototyping showed a problem no contrast figure reveals: a translucent bar at the top of the page sits over the sage, so every page would show a greyed, greenish masthead instead of Priscilla's brown. Glass is only wanted once there is something beneath it.

**A boundary between near-identical washes is invisible and hard at once.** The washes differ by  $\Delta E$  0.8–2.6 in OKLab — at or under the threshold of perception when spread

across 9 rem — so a boundary is only ever seen where it breaks: a band that fades to the wrong neighbour, or a section with no band at all, leaves a hard step that reads as a faint line. A band must fade between the grounds actually either side of it, and be visible enough to be felt.

**A peak reads as a crease.** A boundary that rises and falls through a few evenly weighted stops draws a pointed profile, and the eye finds the point. The adopted band follows a raised cosine across nine stops, which is what the right-hand panel of Figure 4 plots — read back out of the stylesheet rather than redrawn.

**Motion on this site must settle, not perform.** The motion tokens already say *leave quickly, settle slowly, never overshoot*. Cross-document view transitions let a painting carry from the list into its own page. They need a unique name per element on each page; two elements sharing a name abort the whole transition, which rules out naming the lightbox copy.

### 2.5.3 Options

Every option considered is listed. **Adopted** items are built. **Optional** items remain available for a later pass, and where one fails a measured limit the reason says so.

Table 7: Softness options, by area

| Area      | Option                                         | Status                           | Why                                                                            |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edges     | 2 px on controls and panels, 3 px on the sheet | <b>Adopted</b>                   | Softens the pixel-hard corner without changing shape; a mount board is square  |
| Edges     | 8–16 px radii                                  | Optional                         | Reads as an app, not a gallery                                                 |
| Edges     | Rounded corners on the paintings               | Optional — <i>crops the work</i> | Rounding a corner removes part of the object being sold                        |
| Elevation | Three-layer shadows tinted with --bar          | <b>Adopted</b>                   | A brown shadow sits <i>in</i> the paper; a black one sits on it and reads grey |
| Elevation | Single large neutral shadow                    | Optional                         | Reads as a glow                                                                |
| Margins   | Passe-partout: a --paper-deep mat, no outline  | <b>Adopted</b>                   | What a gallery does to a work; defined by tone and shadow, not a line          |

| Area       | Option                                                      | Status                                              | Why                                                                                                |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Margins    | --paper mat with a hairline                                 | Optional                                            | Crisper and more card-like, but adds the line the site avoids                                      |
| Margins    | Shadow only, no mat                                         | Optional                                            | Softer still; loses the mounted look                                                               |
| Margins    | Sheet floating from 900 px, not 1320 px                     | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | On a 1280 px laptop the sheet used to run into the bar                                             |
| Glass      | Masthead at 88%, scroll-driven, desktop                     | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | 7.39:1 over white; solid at rest; nothing passes under it on a phone                               |
| Glass      | Masthead at 60–70%                                          | Optional — <i>fails 4.5:1</i>                       | 3.06–4.11:1 over a white passage                                                                   |
| Glass      | Translucent reading panels over the sage                    | Optional — <i>unbounded contrast</i>                | The sheet is the reading surface; text on glass over a painting has no worst case to solve against |
| Boundaries | The field breathing through each band at 20%                | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | $\Delta E$ 5.3: plainly there when scrolling, a fifth of the way to the sage                       |
| Boundaries | Bands named by, and fading between, their actual neighbours | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | No hard step where a band meets the section beside it                                              |
| Boundaries | Each section its own sheet, with sage between               | Optional                                            | The most emphatic; replaces one mounted sheet with several and doubles the shadows                 |
| Boundaries | The mark set small at the centre of a band                  | Optional                                            | A signpost that repeats the logo on every scroll                                                   |
| Boundaries | A hairline or short sanguine rule                           | Optional — <i>adds a line and spends the accent</i> | Contradicts both principles above                                                                  |
| Motion     | Nav underline drawn in from the left                        | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | A transform, so nothing reflows and the 48 px target is unchanged                                  |
| Motion     | One-pixel button lift, pointer devices only                 | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | On touch, <code>:hover</code> sticks after a tap                                                   |

| Area       | Option                                      | Status                            | Why                                                                      |
|------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Motion     | Mount shadow deepens when a work is hovered | <b>Adopted</b>                    | Elevation without touching the painting                                  |
| Motion     | Lightbox fades and settles 8 px             | <b>Adopted</b>                    | No scale: a painting drawn at 99.5% is drawn wrong                       |
| Motion     | Zoom a painting on hover                    | Optional — <i>alters the work</i> | Implies cropping; no hover on touch                                      |
| Motion     | Scroll-triggered reveals, parallax          | Optional — <i>vestibular risk</i> | Also invisible in a link-card thumbnail and the first frame              |
| Motion     | Animated focus ring                         | Optional — <i>not recommended</i> | A focus indicator must be present the instant focus arrives              |
| Navigation | Masthead held still across page changes     | <b>Adopted</b>                    | Without it the whole bar dissolves and re-forms, which reads as a reload |
| Navigation | The painting carried from list to page      | <b>Adopted</b>                    | Chromium and Safari; elsewhere navigation is simply instant              |
| Navigation | Smooth scrolling for in-page jumps          | Optional                          | A long glide past many large images; already declined                    |

#### 2.5.4 What was built

Nothing in the palette changed. All nine new softness tokens — two radii, three shadows, the mat, the glass opacity and blur, and the boundary breath — are expressed through colours that already existed, and a check fails the build if a literal colour appears among them.

#### 2.5.5 How it is held

- `check-contrast.mjs` composites the bar at `--glass-bar-opacity` over pure white and fails the build below 7:1 for navigation text. Set to the usual 70%, it names three failures.
- `check-render.mjs` lays the built pages out in Chrome and asserts that every painting's box keeps the painting's own proportions to within 1%, with no radius and no transform (Section 5.4).
- Six assertions in `check-review.mjs` (G-01 to G-06) cover the rest: no literal colour in the new tokens, a mat and nothing that alters a painting, glass solid at rest and gated,

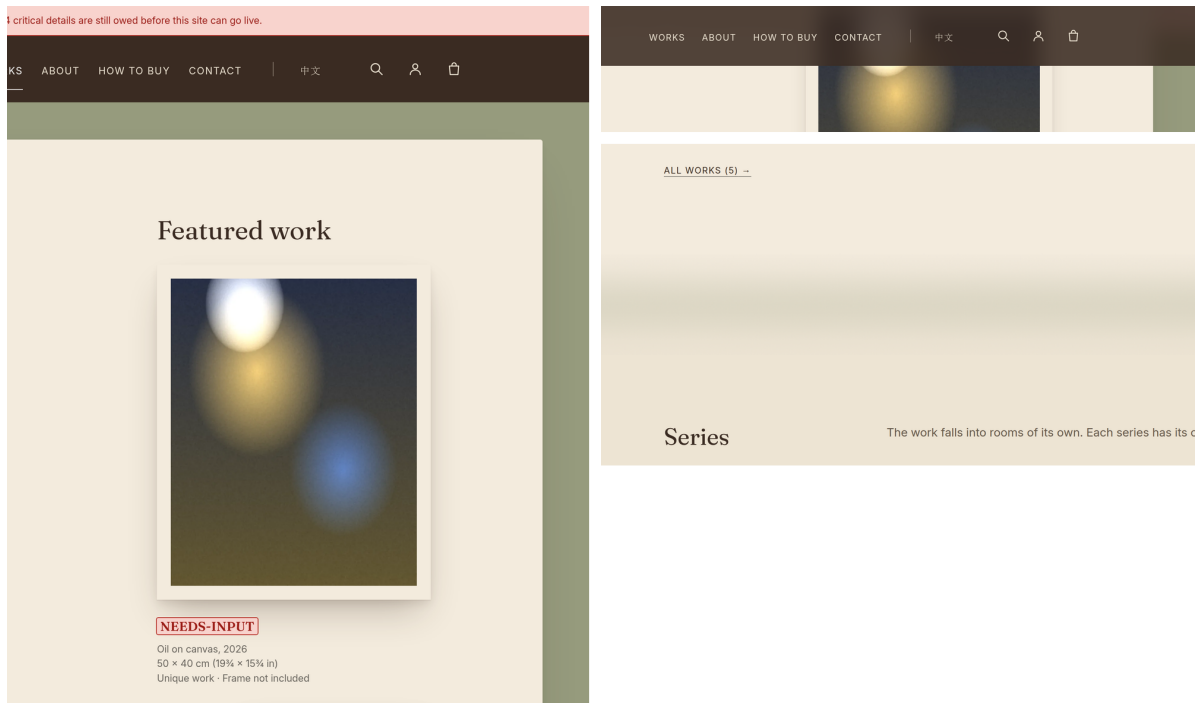


Figure 5: The adopted treatment, with a synthetic stand-in canvas in place of photography that does not exist yet. Left: hover — the navigation underline drawn, the mount lifted, the button raised one pixel. Top right: the glass bar at its scrolled state, with the canvas's near-white highlight beneath it. Bottom right: the homepage boundary between Latest works and Series.

all new motion standing down for reduced motion, one transition name per painting per page, and every band joining the grounds actually either side of it.

## 2.6 The two masters

The brief asked for a debt to Leonardo and to van Gogh, carried without ever announcing itself. The test applied throughout: *a visitor who knows nothing should feel only that the site is calm and well made; a visitor who knows the work should feel recognised.*

### 2.6.1 What was adopted

- **The accent is sanguine.** Red chalk, the medium Leonardo drew in, measures 6.33:1 on white; the oxblood Priscilla chose by eye measures 6.68:1. They are the same colour. The recommendation was to change nothing and record why.
- **No hard edges.** Leonardo's instruction to paint "*without strokes or lines, in the manner of smoke*" and the Chinese 没骨 ("boneless") tradition of painting without contour are the same idea reached independently. For a Chinese painter addressing both audiences that is a structural principle, not a motif. Section boundaries dissolve rather than rule.
- **The rules are van Gogh's stated violet.** He told Theo the *Bedroom* walls were "of a pale violet"; they read blue today because the red lake faded. The site uses the colour he said, not the colour that survived.
- **Hatching runs his way.** Leonardo was left-handed, so his stroke runs upper-left to lower-right. No text source could be retrieved, so the 43.8° angle is an original structure-tensor measurement of his sheets, validated against a right-handed control.



### 2.6.2 What was cut, and why

#### The myth filter

**Golden-ratio grid.** Unsupported. Illustrating Pacioli's *De divina proportione* establishes that Leonardo drew the solids, not that he composed on the ratio.

**"Leonardo invented sfumato", and the word itself.** Cennino Cennini described blending shadows like smoke a century earlier, and Leonardo never used the noun — a full-text search of the *Trattato* returns none.

**Any yellow as text.** Indian yellow is 2.10:1 and zinc yellow 1.53:1. Both are genuine *Starry Night* pigments and both are unusable for anything but a mark inside an image.

**Sampling colours off the paintings.** The *Bedroom* wall as it survives today is 2.78:1; the *Sunflowers* chrome yellow 2.70:1. Both sit within a hair of the 2.67:1 failure this report opens with.

## 2.7 The site's structure

The first build's menu — *Original Works*, *Tribute*, *About*, *How to Buy* — mixed jumps down the homepage with real pages, had no page that listed the works, and could group a work only by a two-value field. None of that survives a catalogue growing past a few dozen works, or a new genre. The structure below replaced it.

### 2.7.1 Method

Six reference sites, chosen to cover the three models this site sits between: artists' own sites (David Hockney, Kehinde Wiley Studio), galleries (David Zwirner, Victoria Miro) and marketplaces for original work (Saatchi Art, Artfinder). Each was **rendered in headless Chrome**, not fetched as HTML: two of the six build their navigation and filters with scripts, and a plain fetch reported Saatchi as having no filters at all. Navigation, hierarchy, breadcrumbs and side columns were read from the rendered page and checked against a screenshot. Three first choices could not be used: Gerhard Richter's site was offline, Hauser & Wirth rate-limited the request, and Artsy refused it.

Counting `<aside>` elements suggested four of the six had sidebars; every one was a region-settings pop-up, so only the rendered layout was trusted.

### 2.7.2 What the six agree on

Columns: **H** Hockney · **W** Kehinde Wiley · **Z** David Zwirner · **VM** Victoria Miro · **S** Saatchi Art · **A** Artfinder.

Table 8: The six reference sites, September 2026

| Pattern                                       | H | W | Z | VM | S | A | Majority     |
|-----------------------------------------------|---|---|---|----|---|---|--------------|
| Works under one entry; no series beside About | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓  | ✓ | ✓ | <b>6 / 6</b> |
| Buying reachable from the header              | — | ✓ | ✓ | ✓  | ✓ | ✓ | <b>5 / 6</b> |
| Contact reachable from the header             | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓  | — | — | <b>4 / 6</b> |
| A navigation sidebar                          | — | — | — | —  | — | — | <b>0 / 6</b> |
| Highlights or latest in a sidebar             | — | — | — | —  | — | — | <b>0 / 6</b> |
| A filter sidebar                              | — | — | — | —  | ✓ | ✓ | <b>2 / 6</b> |
| Breadcrumbs                                   | ✓ | — | — | —  | ✓ | ✓ | <b>3 / 6</b> |
| <i>How to buy</i> as a header page            | — | — | — | —  | — | — | <b>0 / 6</b> |

Two things the table does not show. The filter sidebars both belong to marketplaces listing tens of thousands of works — Artfinder's showed *60 of 25,000*. And where an artist's own site organises a large body of work, it does it one level down: Hockney's *Works* opens onto media, and within *Paintings* a horizontal row of decades.

### 2.7.3 The sidebar question

No. Not for navigation, highlights or anything latest.

- **None of the six uses one for navigation or highlights.**
- **Right-hand columns are not looked at.** Eye-tracking puts desktop attention on right-rail content at 0.8% of fixations: people have learned that the side column is where advertising lives, and avoid it whatever it holds.<sup>1</sup>
- **Local navigation is for large sections.** It earns its space when visitors browse and compare many sibling pages, and is not needed for small ones; when it is used it should be less prominent than the global navigation.<sup>2</sup>

<sup>1</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Fight against "right-rail blindness" and Banner blindness revisited](#).

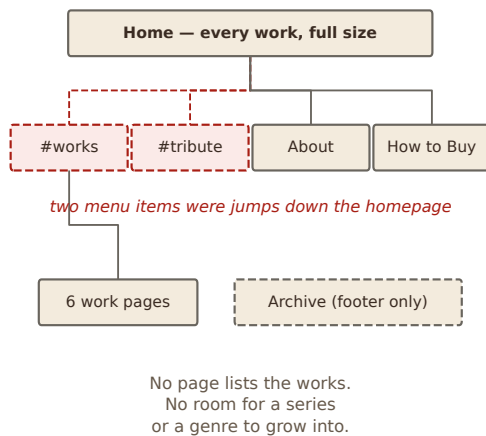
<sup>2</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Local navigation is a valuable orientation and wayfinding aid](#).

- **Filters belong beside the grid only when there are many of them.** Sidebar filters are often overlooked because they sit where navigation and banners usually are; a horizontal row above the results works for up to six to eight filter types, and a sidebar is the better choice beyond that.<sup>3</sup>

Where this site needs what a sidebar would carry, it gets it in the reading path instead: the *latest* works are a homepage section, each series is a room with its own page, and the Works section's rooms are one quiet row of tabs.

### 2.7.4 What was built

#### Before



#### After

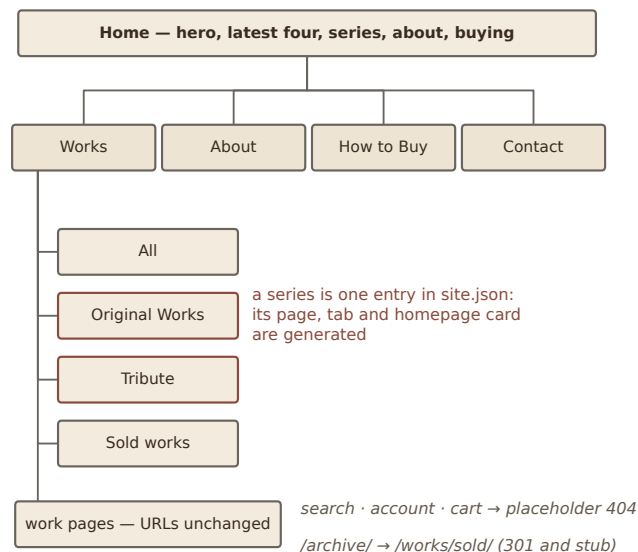


Figure 6: The site map before and after. The after tree is drawn from `site.json`, the same data the build generates the navigation and series from.

- **The header goes to four real pages:** *Works*, *About*, *How to Buy*, *Contact* (作品, 关于, 购买方式, 联系), and marks the one the visitor is in — page on the section's own page, true beneath it.
- **Works is the catalogue.** `/works/` lists every available work, newest first, with a row of tabs: *All*, *Original Works*, *Tribute*, *Sold works*, each with its count. Each series is a room at `/works/series/{id}/`; sold works moved from `/archive/` to `/works/sold/`.

<sup>3</sup>Baymard Institute, *Be careful with horizontal filtering toolbars*.

- **Series are data.** A series is one entry in `site.json`; its page, its tab and its homepage card are generated from it, and the build refuses a work that names an undeclared series or genre, or a slug that would collide with a page under `/works/`.
- **The homepage is a front door, not the catalogue:** van Gogh's line beside one *Featured work*, the four *Latest works* with a link to all of them and their number, a card for each series, About, and How to Buy.
- **Breadcrumbs from the second level down**, with the current page as text and a work's trail running through its one series (*Home / Works / Tribute / ...*), and published as structured data. The top level has none: there is nothing above it to return to.
- **Nothing that was shared breaks.** Work pages keep their addresses. `/archive/` answers with a 301 on Cloudflare Pages and with a redirecting page on hosts that cannot send one.

### 2.7.5 Where it stays personal

The consensus decides the shape; the site keeps its own character inside it.

- **Tribute keeps its room.** The van Gogh epigraph and the hatch texture that marked its homepage section now mark its series page — the room it belongs in — and it has a card of its own on the homepage.
- **The front door keeps the gallery's voice:** the motto, one painting, and the sfumato bands between sections, each still joining the grounds either side of it.
- **One departure from the six.** None of them puts *How to Buy* in the header, and here it stays there. The six either take cards through an ordinary checkout or sell to collectors who expect to enquire. This site sells across a border, without cards, with import duty the buyer has to anticipate, and with its cart still a placeholder; how buying works is a question a visitor has before they have chosen anything. When the cart works, *How to Buy* moves to the footer and the cart becomes the header's way in to buying — as five of the six have it.

### 2.7.6 How it grows

The depth is fixed at three levels below the homepage — *Works / series / work* — because more than a few levels is where visitors lose their way;<sup>4</sup> growth is added across, not down.

<sup>4</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, *Flat vs. deep website hierarchies*.

Table 9: Growth rules

| When                                                    | Then                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A new series is added                                   | One entry in <code>site.json</code> ; page, tab and card follow. Asserted (I-03)                                                                                                               |
| Genres come into use: two or more among available works | A horizontal genre filter row on <code>/works/</code> . A genre is a filter, never a fourth level: a landscape in <i>Tribute</i> is in one room and matches two filters <sup>5</sup>           |
| The Works tabs pass eight, or filter types pass eight   | The Works navigation moves to a left column on desktop — the one case the research supports a sidebar. The eight-tab ceiling is asserted today (I-06), so the change cannot happen by accident |
| More than six series                                    | The homepage shows six series cards and a link to all                                                                                                                                          |
| About gains pages — CV, exhibitions, press              | About gets its own row of tabs, as Works has                                                                                                                                                   |
| The cart takes payments                                 | <i>How to Buy</i> leaves the header for the footer                                                                                                                                             |

### 2.7.7 How it is held

Assertions I-01 to I-06: the header links to four real pages and marks the current one; every work is listed exactly once — on *Works*, on its series page, or among sold works; the homepage shows at most four and states how many there are; a series needs only data; deeper pages carry a breadcrumb whose last step is the page itself; the old address still arrives; and no navigation lives in a side column. The render check covers the catalogue, both series pages and sold works.

## 2.8 The site as built

Five captures of the preview build, four on a desktop and one on a phone. They are not mockups: `docs/report/shots.sh` takes them from `dist/` each time this document is built, so they show the site as it is. The ribbon across the top of each page and the red NEEDS-INPUT flags are the preview's; a release has neither (Section 5.5).

<sup>5</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Polyhierarchies improve findability for ambiguous IA categories](#).

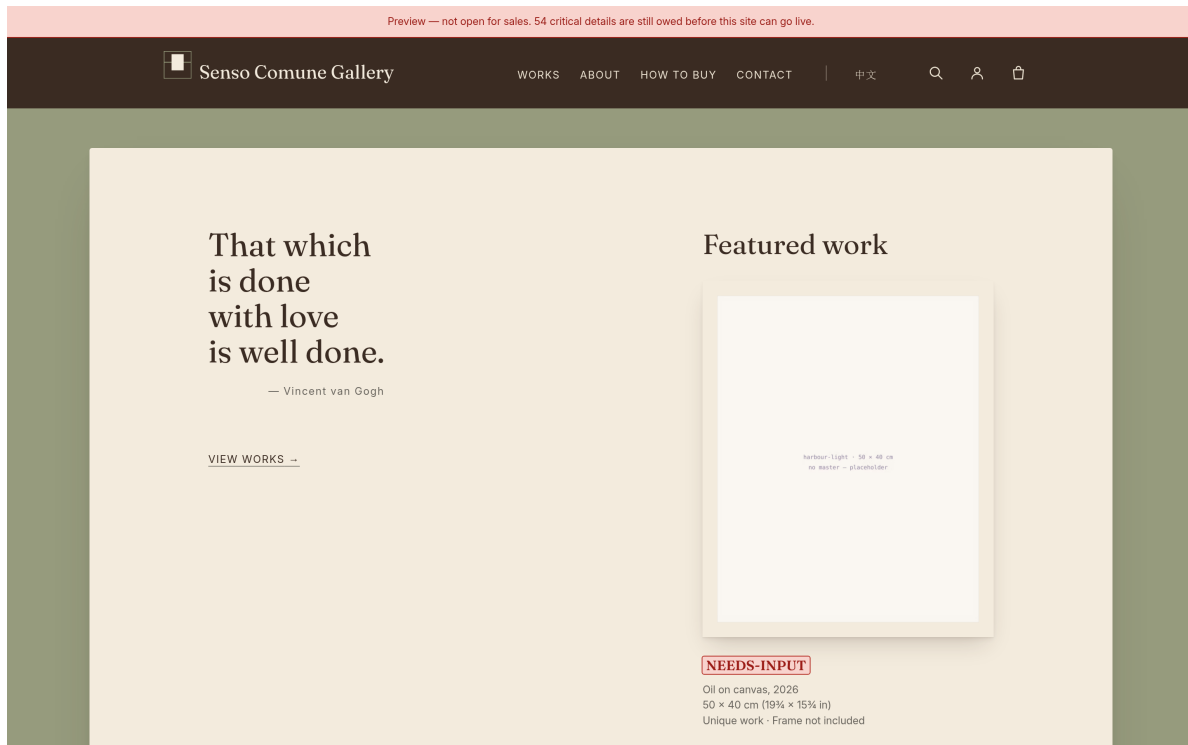


Figure 7: The homepage. Cream sheet mounted on the sage field, dark brown bar, the mark at the head of the wordmark, and search, account and cart at the right. Van Gogh's line, in his own words from letter 143 to Theo — *that which is done with love is well done* — is attributed beneath it, aligned to its longest line, beside the featured work; on a phone the line leads and the work follows.

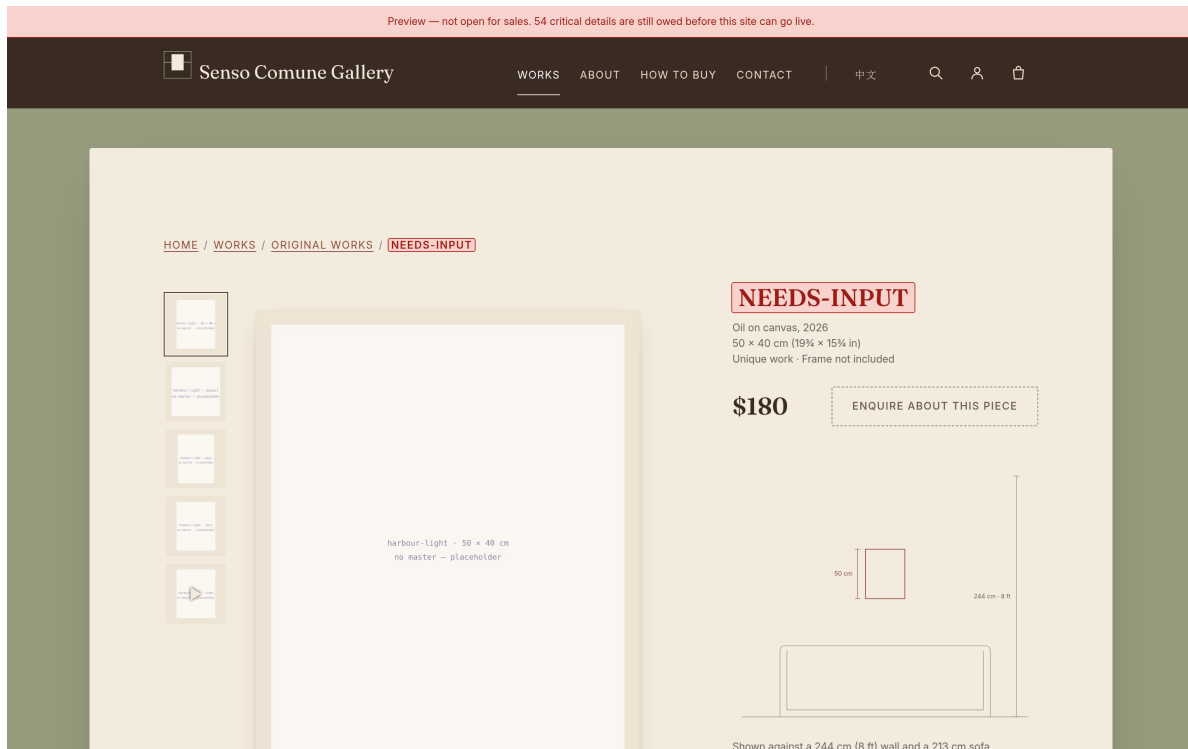


Figure 8: A work page. The views of the work — front, detail, edge, back and video — sit in a strip with thumbnails always visible, grey placeholders until the photographs exist. The price is the boldest element in the block. The scale diagram shows the painting against a 244 cm wall and a 213 cm sofa, hung at the museum standard of 144.78 cm, which is also where the mark's datum sits.

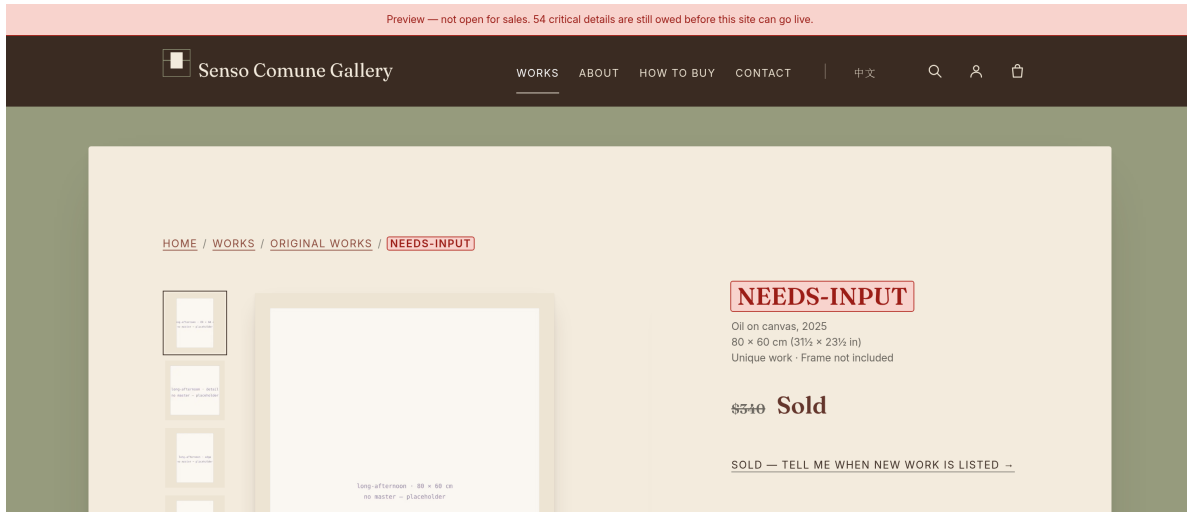


Figure 9: The sold state. The price stays visible as social proof, "Sold" sits at full contrast in the price position, and the call-to-action slot becomes a capture rather than a dead end.

## 2.9 The design review

The built site was reviewed in September as a designer rather than as its author. Nineteen findings, in five groups; eighteen were implemented, and each is held by an assertion of the same number in `check-review.mjs`.





Figure 10: The homepage on a 390 px phone. The masthead takes two rows — the short name and the shop bar, then the sections and the language switch — and does not stick: a sticky masthead that tall would take a third of the screen and hide the focused item. Van Gogh's line comes before the featured work.

Table 10: What the review changed, by group

| Group                       | No. | What shipped                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Selling            | 4   | A painting moved into the hero beside the motto; a <code>mailto:</code> link stopped calling itself <i>Buy</i> ; How to Buy gained reachable contact details; the price and its button were bound into one block                                                          |
| <b>B</b> Contrast and craft | 4   | A footer grey at <b>2.34:1</b> — shipped, not theoretical — was removed; the contrast checker was taught to resolve the cascade rather than read declarations; the scale diagram's linework went from 1.73:1 to <b>3.24:1</b> and its labels from 3.05:1 to <b>4.90:1</b> |
| <b>C</b> Reach              | 4   | The icon set, <code>theme-color</code> and manifest (Section 2.4); Open Graph typed as a product with price and availability; the sage field restored on a phone                                                                                                          |
| <b>D</b> Reading            | 5   | Prose pages given a narrower mount; the archive set as a grid rather than a second selling gallery; the gallery name made the <code>h1</code> ; dead rules deleted                                                                                                        |
| <b>E</b> Fonts              | 2   | The Chinese subset's coverage is now asserted at build time, and each locale preloads only the face it uses                                                                                                                                                               |

Two were not fixes. **C-04** proposed freezing the wordmark in English; it was declined, and the wordmark still translates — which is what later decided the logo (Section 2.4). And half of **B-03** was wrong: the scale diagram's painting and sofa were said to be off-axis, and are centred. Its contrast half was real, and is the measurement above.

## PART 3

# Money

## 3.1 Paying

### 3.1.1 The constraint

**Stripe is not available**

Mainland China is absent from Stripe's supported business countries. Hong Kong, Singapore and Japan are present. This is not the narrower finding about PayPal — it is the whole account.

Airwallex looked like the answer and is more restricted than it appears. A mainland entity can open an account for Global Accounts, foreign exchange and transfers, but card acquiring is excluded in Airwallex's own Chinese-language terms, and it opens no personal accounts at all.

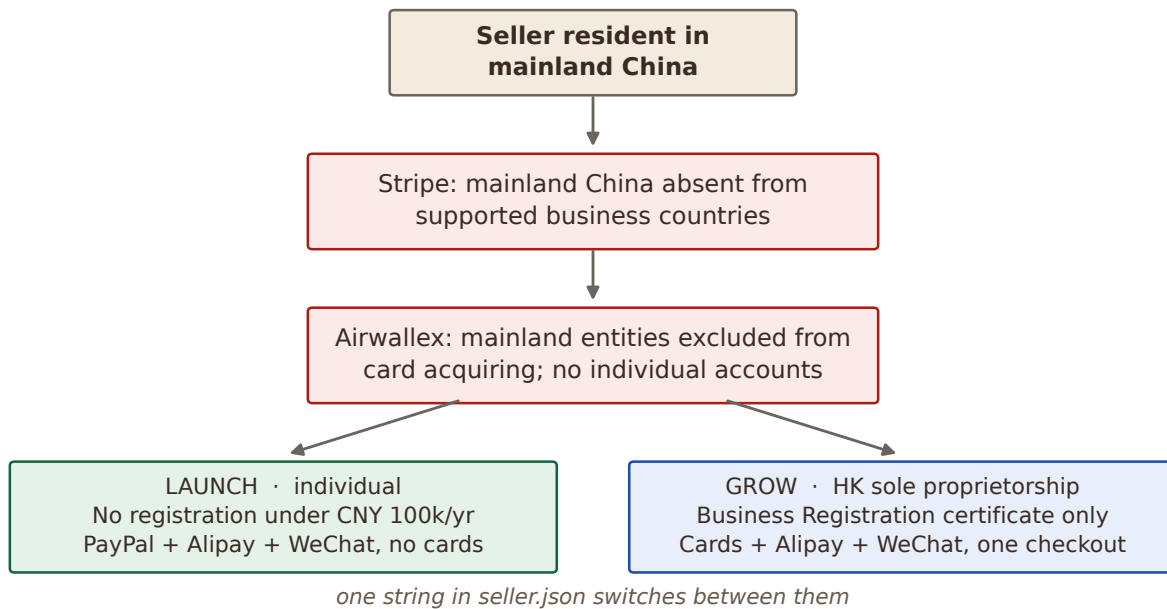


Figure 11: The two routes, and the one string that switches between them.

### 3.1.2 Route A — launch as an individual

At this turnover, four obligations that would normally apply do not.

Table 11: What the individual route does not require

| Requirement           | Position                                                                              | Authority                 |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Business registration | <b>Not required</b> under CNY 100,000/yr online turnover                              | SAMR Order 37, Art. 8 ¶13 |
| FX annual quota       | <b>Not consumed</b> — cross-border e-commerce settles outside it                      | 汇发〔2020〕14号 Art. 66(2)    |
| BOP declaration       | <b>Not filed</b> — resident individuals exempt at or below USD 10,000 per transaction | 汇发〔2022〕22号 Art. 8        |
| VAT                   | <b>Exempt</b> — monthly sales under CNY 100,000, to 31 Dec 2027                       | 财政部/税务总局 2023 年第 19 号     |

Six works at \$60–\$440 is roughly CNY 19,000 — an order of magnitude below the registration ceiling.

#### What Priscilla must not do

Route sale proceeds as a gift or family remittance; split transactions to stay under a threshold; or use informal currency swaps. The last is 私自买卖外汇 under Article 45 of the FX Regulations, and published enforcement puts the penalty on the offender's PBOC credit file.

### 3.1.3 Route B — a Hong Kong sole proprietorship

A Business Registration certificate is sufficient — no incorporation. That unlocks the free Airwallex plan with no-code payment links, international cards at 3.60% + HK\$2.35, **and Alipay and WeChat Pay** as merchant methods, which is how the domestic half of the audience is served from one checkout.

It also unlocks repatriation: Airwallex supports local CNY transfer for sellers without a mainland registered business whose ultimate beneficial owner is a Chinese national exporting goods from the mainland. That describes this business exactly.

### Confirm before incorporating

Airwallex approves its Payments product **separately** from account opening, and reviews the live site as part of that review. The entity list verified covers account opening only.

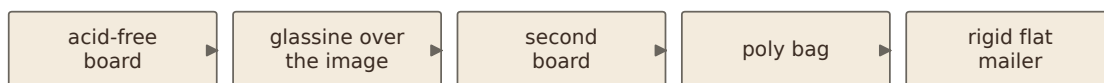
### 3.1.4 Rejected

**Payoneer Checkout** is Stripe-powered, excludes mainland China explicitly, and requires monthly volumes above USD 20,000 — roughly 130× this business. **PingPong** and **Lian-Lian** both have real independent-site acquiring, but neither publishes pricing or eligibility and both are sales-led. Do not design around either without a written quote.

## 3.2 Shipping

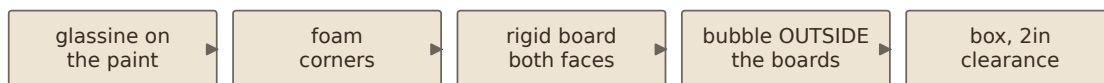
### Works on paper

flat, never rolled — rolling cracks the sizing



### Stretched canvas

upright, never flat — and never below freezing



Materials run \$25-50 per shipment. Every carrier's artwork declared-value caps sits above this inventory.

Figure 12: How each kind of work travels. The paper rule is the one most often got wrong.

### Works on paper ship flat, never rolled

Rolling cracks the paper's sizing and can crease or smear the media. Tubes are a fallback for very large **unstretched** canvas only.

Stretched canvas ships upright, never flat, with the bubble wrap outside the rigid boards so nothing touches the paint. Cold is a real hazard: linseed oil stiffens and can crack below freezing, which matters for winter shipping.

The much-discussed “\$1,000 artwork cap” does not bind here. FedEx caps declared value on art at \$1,000 or \$9.07/lb, whichever is greater; USPS additional insurance for artwork caps around \$1,000. Every one of those caps sits above this entire inventory.

3.3 Duty and tax at the border

The site cannot say “duty-free” to US buyers

Original paintings under HS 9701 carry a **Free** base rate, which is where the belief comes from. For a **China-origin** shipment in 2026 it is wrong.

- **Section 301 List 4A applies.** HTSUS 9903.88.15 imposes **+7.5%** on products of China, and US note 20(s)(i) enumerates 9701.91.00 — contemporary paintings — among the covered subheadings. The exclusion that once covered paintings is expired.
- **De minimis is suspended.** The \$800 exemption no longer applies, so every painting needs a customs entry.
- **The IEEPA tariffs are gone** — struck down and revoked in February 2026 — and artworks were separately carved out of them as “informational materials”. That relief does **not** extend to Section 301.

A \$300 painting, China origin, delivered to the United States



Figure 13: What a US buyer actually pays on a \$300 painting.

Table 12: Import treatment by destination

| Destination   | Duty                     | VAT / tax | Confidence |
|---------------|--------------------------|-----------|------------|
| United States | <b>+7.5%</b> Section 301 | —         | Verified   |

| Destination    | Duty                            | VAT / tax                         | Confidence                        |
|----------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| United Kingdom | 0%, ERGA OMNES (origin-neutral) | Reduced art rate                  | Verified                          |
| European Union | 0% expected                     | Reduced art rate per member state | <b>Unverified — see Section 7</b> |

### 3.4 The donation pledge

The draft said “10% of each order goes toward research”, which is a per-transaction consumer promise. The site now says “*I personally donate 10% of my profits each quarter*” — a personal pledge, which is a materially different representation.

What protects the pledge is not the wording but the receipts: a public page with the recipient named, the basis stated, the cadence disclosed, and a running cumulative total.

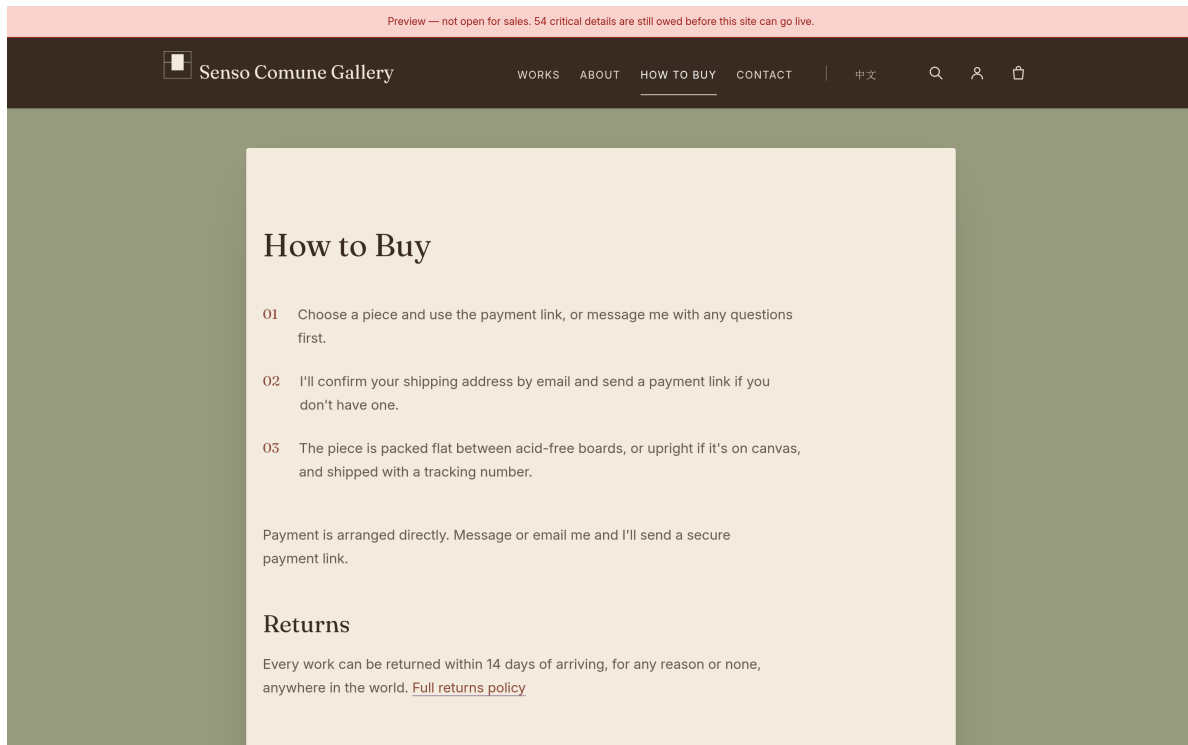


Figure 14: The How to Buy page, which puts the duty figure in front of the buyer before they commit rather than after.



## PART 4

# Law and access

## 4.1 Returns

### Returns cannot be refused, in either market

**China.** Consumer Protection Law Art. 25 gives a seven-day no-reason return on distance sales. The exceptions are a **closed list** — SAIC Order 90 Art. 6 excludes only goods made to the consumer's order, perishables, unsealed digital media and delivered periodicals. The 2024 Implementing Regulations Art. 19 then expressly forbid a trader expanding that list, and ban pre-ticked exclusion.

**European Union.** CRD Art. 16(c) excepts goods "made to the consumer's specifications or clearly personalised". **Uniqueness is not personalisation** — the test is whether the *buyer* specified it. A pre-existing painting chosen from a catalogue fails that test.

A "governed by PRC law" clause does not help: Rome I Art. 6(2) prevents a choice of law from depriving a consumer of protections that cannot be derogated from under their home law, where the trader directs activity there. Offering EU shipping at checkout is directing activity.

**One worldwide 14-day policy** over-satisfies the Chinese seven days, removes any need to geo-detect buyers, and avoids a seven-day policy reading as an attempt to shorten the EU right. Commissions are the one genuine exception under both regimes.

## 4.2 Disclosure

One block of address, phone and email satisfies three regimes at once: the EU Consumer Rights Directive Art. 6(1)(c), the Chinese requirement, and the UK anticipatory duty. Alongside it, SAMR Order 37 Art. 12 prescribes the exact sentence an unregistered individual seller must publish:

个人从事零星小额交易活动，依法不需要办理市场主体登记

That string is quoted verbatim from the rule and must not be paraphrased.

## 4.3 Privacy

PIPL applies, and costs a privacy page and a one-page impact assessment — no more. Processing necessary to conclude and perform the sale needs **no consent checkbox** — a just-in-time notice at the email field is the correct pattern, and consent is reserved for the newsletter. No PRC representative and no regulator filing are required, because those provisions bind handlers *outside* China. The overseas hosting is exempt from the CAC transfer mechanisms both as contract-necessary and on volume.

## 4.4 Accessibility

### 4.4.1 The legal position

Calmer than the compliance industry suggests. A one-person operation is almost certainly exempt from the European Accessibility Act as a microenterprise providing services. The stronger argument for the work is commercial: **a blind collector who cannot read the descriptions cannot buy the painting.**

### 4.4.2 What was built

Table 13: Accessibility work, by criterion

| Criterion                 | What it required                                                | Status                                             |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1.4.3 Contrast            | Every CTA was 2.67:1                                            | Filled ink control at 11.45:1                      |
| 1.4.1 Use of colour       | No accent reaches 3:1 against body text                         | Underlines on body links, structurally             |
| 2.4.7 / 1.4.11 Focus      | A single-colour ring dies over a dark painting                  | Two-tone ring, works on any ground                 |
| 2.4.11 Focus not obscured | Sticky nav can hide the focused item                            | <code>scroll-padding-top</code> ; static on mobile |
| 2.5.8 Target size         | Nav bars are not sentences; the inline exception does not apply | 48 px via padding                                  |
| 1.1.1 Non-text content    | Six paintings, no alt text                                      | Three-layer description per work                   |
| 2.4.4 Link purpose        | Six identical “Buy” links in the links list                     | Visually-hidden span per control                   |

#### 4.4.3 Describing a painting

The “125-character limit” is folklore — there is none in the HTML specification or in WCAG. The citable number is Cooper Hewitt’s **approximately fifteen words**.

The guidance genuinely disagrees on interpretation: the DIAGRAM Center says never interpret, Cooper Hewitt says interpret when it aids visual understanding. For an artist’s own gallery Cooper Hewitt is right — but interpretation stays textually separable, labelled “Artist’s note”, placed last, and never allowed to replace observation.

##### On AI-drafted descriptions

Acceptable as a first pass, never as shipped text. A model can report palette, format and apparent handling. It cannot know the true medium, the real dimensions, the title, or the intent — which is exactly what a buyer needs. A wrong description is worse than none, because it burns trust in the channel.

## PART 5

# The build

## 5.1 Shape

Plain Node, no framework. Thirty-six pages generated from three data files, with sharp the only dependency — which is the only architecture consistent with a design whose argument is restraint.

|                  |                                                            |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| src/data/        | site.json · seller.json · artworks.json                    |
|                  | readiness-waivers.json      signed exceptions to the gate  |
| src/styles/      | tokens.css · base.css · gallery.css                        |
| src/scripts/     | gallery.js      the work-page views, enhanced              |
| src/templates.js |                                                            |
| build.js         | 36 pages, two locales, and the 404                         |
| scripts/         | mark.mjs      the logo, shared with this report            |
|                  | build-fonts · build-fonts-cjk · build-images · build-icons |
|                  | readiness · check-readiness · test-readiness · release     |
|                  | check-contrast · check-links · check-review · check-render |
|                  | preview.mjs      one page, inlined, for review             |
| docs/            | brief/ · report/                                           |

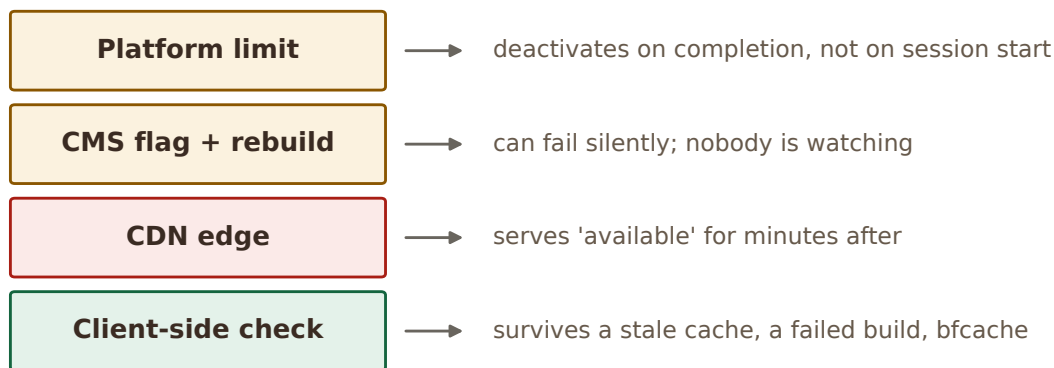
The page count follows the data: eighteen pages per locale for six works in two series, of which six are work pages.

## 5.2 The entity switch

One string in `seller.json` moves the whole site between the two commercial routes:

```
"activeEntity": "individual" → "hk-sole-prop"
```

That switches the published legal disclosure, the invoicing language, the checkout provider and the returns basis together. No template knows which entity is active.



No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The bottom layer is the cheapest, and the only one that survives the other three failing.

Figure 15: Defence in depth. Each layer above the bottom one fails in a way the bottom one survives.

### 5.3 Overselling

No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The client-side availability check is roughly forty lines and is the only layer that survives a stale CDN page, a silently failed rebuild or a bfcache restore.

Alongside it, a published policy costs nothing and settles the residual case: *in the rare event two people buy the same piece at once, the first completed payment stands and the second is refunded in full within 24 hours.*

### 5.4 Checks that block the build

`npm run check` runs the first four anywhere, in seconds. The rendering check needs Chrome; GitHub runs it on every preview, and the release runs all of them.

Table 14: The checks

| Check                       | What fails it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>check-contrast</code> | Any token below its floor on the darkest ground it is painted on — resolving the cascade, so the declaration that actually wins is the one measured — and the glass bar under 7:1 over white                                                                                                                         |
| <code>check-links</code>    | A dead link; missing <code>alt</code> , <code>width</code> or <code>height</code> ; heading order; landmarks; <code>hreflang</code> ; a Chinese character the font subset does not cover; a placeholder route that resolves. In a release, any <code>NEEDS-INPUT</code> or placeholder at all                        |
| <code>check-review</code>   | <b>66 assertions over 46 findings</b> — the design review, the mark, softness, the shop bar and views, the structure, the flags and the gate — written against the built pages, so a fix that stops being applied fails the build                                                                                    |
| <code>test-readiness</code> | Any of <b>43 tests</b> showing the gate opens only when it should (Section 5.5.3)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <code>check-render</code>   | In Chrome, at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px across 12 pages: a painting out of its own proportions, rounded or transformed; a masthead that overflows, takes more than two rows or has a control under 44 px; van Gogh's line re-wrapped, its attribution off its edge, or the featured work ahead of it on a phone |

Headless Chrome will not lay a page out narrower than 500 px — asked for 390, it lays out at 500 and crops. Phone widths are therefore laid out inside an `iframe` of exactly that width, with scrollbars hidden, and the check asserts the width the page actually received.

#### A test that passes for the wrong reason

One of the review fixes `set font-size:var(--size-h1)`. No such token exists — the scale calls it `--size-hero` — so the rule silently fell back to inherited body size, and the assertion written for it passed because it only matched the declaration's text. The repair was a cross-cutting assertion that every `var(--token)` in the shipped stylesheet resolves to a definition. An undefined custom property is the one CSS error that produces no error.

### The limit of automation

Automated testing decides roughly 13–30% of WCAG success criteria and catches almost none of the focus-order and focus-visibility failures that block people outright. The checks are a floor, not a pass.

## 5.5 Readiness

The site must not go live until every critical detail is supplied. A list of fields marked NEEDS-INPUT is not enough to ensure that: an empty email, `test@example.com` or a placeholder photograph contains no such word, and a list that is printed does not stop a build that is published. The readiness gate checks what is in each field, and a release cannot be built while it is closed.

### 5.5.1 What the research says

- **Fail closed.** When a control cannot establish that it is safe to proceed, it should stop rather than carry on — the security principle usually called *failing securely*.<sup>6</sup> For this site the unsafe state is a shop that looks open and is not lawful or not honest.
- **The law names what is critical.** For distance sales to EU consumers, the trader's identity, geographical address, telephone number and email, the main characteristics of the goods, the total price and the arrangements for payment must all be given.<sup>7</sup> China's E-Commerce Law requires the business licence information — or the statement that registration is not required — to be shown continuously in a prominent place on the homepage.<sup>8</sup>
- **Validate values, not words.** A real email address is best checked against the definition every browser uses, a deliberate, practical subset of RFC 5322.<sup>9</sup> Some names are reserved precisely so they can never be real — `example.com`, `.test`, `.invalid`<sup>10</sup> — which makes an address on one an example nobody replaced. A telephone number in international form has a country code and at most fifteen digits.<sup>11</sup> A WeChat ID is six to twenty letters, digits, underscores or hyphens, beginning with a letter.<sup>12</sup>

<sup>6</sup>OWASP, [Fail securely](#).

<sup>7</sup>Directive 2011/83/EU on consumer rights, [Article 6\(1\)](#), points (a), (b), (c), (e) and (g); [Article 9\(1\)](#) for the 14-day withdrawal period.

<sup>8</sup>中华人民共和国电子商务法, [第十五条](#).

<sup>9</sup>WHATWG HTML Standard, [valid e-mail address](#).

<sup>10</sup>[RFC 2606](#), Reserved Top Level DNS Names; see also [RFC 6761](#).

<sup>11</sup>ITU-T Recommendation [E.164](#).

<sup>12</sup>WeChat Help Center, [How do I set my WeChat ID?](#)

- **Gates must be visible.** A documented case from this month: a Cloudflare Pages production build failed, the previous version kept being served, and every check on the repository stayed green, so nobody knew.<sup>13</sup> A gate on the host alone is necessary and not sufficient.

### 5.5.2 How it works

- **A rules engine over the data** (`scripts/readiness.mjs`): 26 rules, each with an area, a severity, the condition under which it applies, the fix, and the law or finding it rests on. It reads nothing and writes nothing, so the build, the report and the tests ask the same question.
- **Values, with the word as backstop.** Every critical field has a rule that checks what is in it; a final rule catches `NEEDS-INPUT`, *TODO*, *lorem ipsum* and the like anywhere no specific rule reaches, and reports only what no other rule already has.
- **Conditions.** Hong Kong registration numbers apply only while that entity is active; the transaction ceiling only once the cart takes payments; a donation recipient only while the pledge is above zero. A conditional rule *owns* its fields, so the backstop cannot block on a field its rule has deliberately set aside.
- **Undecided is not declined.** An optional channel is either a handle or "", which removes it from the site. Left as `NEEDS-INPUT` it is undecided, and blocks.
- **Preview by default; release by request.** Any build not explicitly a release is a preview: noindex on every page, a ribbon saying it is not open for sales and how many details are owed, and — while anything is owed — purchase controls that are drawn but cannot be used. A release asks the gate before building and again inside the build, which refuses *before* clearing the previous output.
- **Nothing of the preview survives a release.** In release mode the link check fails on a single `NEEDS-INPUT` anywhere — attributes and structured data included — on any placeholder photograph, video or asset, on the ribbon, and on any unusable button. Views without photographs are left out rather than shown.
- **Waivers with an expiry.** A blocker that can wait may be waived with a reason, a name and a date; expired or unsigned waivers do not count, and every live one is printed in every report and written into the release. Identity, the registration disclosure, returns, prices, dimensions, photographs and payment links cannot be waived — a waiver naming one keeps the gate shut. That includes the Chinese registration declaration, which must match the rule's wording character for character (rule LG-01).
- **Loud where it matters.** The production host's build command is the release script, so a closed gate is never published; a *Release check* workflow runs the same script on GitHub and fails red with the report on the run's summary page, and the preview workflow shows the report on every run.

<sup>13</sup>[tallyfy/documentation #242](#): the pipeline stays green when the Cloudflare Pages build that publishes the site fails.



Table 15: The rules, by area

| Area                 | Rules | Examples of what blocks                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity and contact | 6     | An email on a reserved domain; a phone number without country code; an address in one language; a malformed WeChat ID; an optional channel left undecided                        |
| Legal                | 4     | The SAMR declaration edited by a single character; the Hong Kong entity active without its numbers; returns under 14 days; a pledge with no recipient                            |
| The site             | 2     | An <code>example</code> or <code>http</code> site address; a header control that leads to the 404                                                                                |
| Works and prices     | 7     | No work for sale; a title as <i>TODO</i> ; alt text as an ellipsis; a price of 0; a currency that is not ISO 4217; a work dated next year; a payment link over <code>http</code> |
| Photography          | 3     | A work for sale still showing its placeholder; a real view photograph with no description                                                                                        |
| Payments             | 3     | No way to pay on the active entity; a live cart with no transaction ceiling                                                                                                      |
| Backstop             | 1     | A placeholder in any field no rule names                                                                                                                                         |

### 5.5.3 How it is proved

- **The gate opens when it should.** A copy of the data with every critical detail supplied passes; 32 single breakages each close it on the named rule; five waiver cases — valid, expired, unsigned, scoped to another field, and aimed at a rule that cannot be waived — each behave as specified. 43 tests, in `npm run check`; weakening the 14-day rule or the reserved-domain list turns them red.
- **End to end, on completed data.** With the fields temporarily supplied and the three header placeholders waived, the release ran: 0 blockers, 36 pages, no `NEEDS-INPUT` anywhere, no ribbon, all 40 purchase controls live, views without photographs omitted, the three waivers written into `readiness.json`, and every check green in release mode. The real data was then restored.
- **It refuses on today's data** — exit 1 at the readiness step — and assertion K-03 checks on every run that a refused release leaves the last built site untouched.

#### 5.5.4 Today

The gate reports **54 blockers**: 36 in the works (titles, alt text and descriptions, in two languages), 5 photographs, 7 identity and contact details, the site's real address, the donation recipient, and the three header placeholders. Most are typing. One is a decision: search, account and cart block a release until those pages exist, or until someone signs a waiver for them.

`npm run readiness` prints the list, each with the field, what is wrong, how to fix it and why it matters. On the preview, every placeholder a reader can see is also flagged in red on its own pale ground, and the flag goes the moment the field is filled; placeholders inside alt text, page titles and link previews cannot carry a flag and are on the printed list instead.

## PART 6

## The work page and the shop bar

---

Two requests, researched together because they meet on the same page: a work page that gives a visitor *enough views* of a painting, modelled on three reference shops, and the *search · account · cart* trio that sits top-right on nearly every shop. Five decisions were taken on 17 September 2026 (Section 6.4). The views and the shop bar are built; the buy box, and the cart, search and account behind the shop bar, are specified and not yet built (Section 6.6).

### 6.1 What the reference shops do

Table 16: Three reference work pages, as they stood in September 2026

|           | +ART Gallery (Shopify)                                                              | Saatchi Art                                                                                    | National Gallery of Art shop      |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Gallery   | Left thumbnail rail: four stills and a fifth with a media badge                     | Left thumbnail rail: the work, a detail, two views in a furnished room                         | One image, no thumbnails          |
| Size cues | Dimensions in the details                                                           | Dimensions; room views; web AR                                                                 | Dimensions in the description     |
| Buy box   | Title, vendor, price with tax line; quantity stepper; add to cart; one-click wallet | Title, artist, medium, size, "ships in a tube"; price; instalments; add to cart; make an offer | Title, SKU, price; add to cart    |
| Assurance | Payment-method badges; accordions for shipping, delivery, contact                   | Shipping included; 14-day guarantee; review score                                              | None beyond price and tax         |
| Pressure  | "Hurry, only 1 left" bar                                                            | None visible                                                                                   | None                              |
| Share     | Facebook, X, Pinterest                                                              | Favourite count; add to collection                                                             | Facebook, X, Pinterest            |
| Header    | Search field, log in, cart with count                                               | Search, log in / register, cart with count                                                     | Search, log in, bag with subtotal |

Saatchi's is the closest model for a painter: it is the only one whose thumbnails answer the question a buyer of a unique object actually has — *what will this look like on my wall?*

## 6.2 What the research says

**Thumbnails, always.** Every desktop site in Baymard's benchmark shows thumbnails for additional images; 76% of mobile sites do not. Where only dot indicators are shown, half of desktop test users had difficulty finding the additional images, and users missed the one that would have answered their question. On mobile, a partly visible last thumbnail signals that more exist.<sup>14</sup>

<sup>14</sup>Baymard Institute, *Always use thumbnails to represent additional product images*.

**At least one image in scale.** 42% of users try to judge a product's size from its images, and 28% of sites give them nothing to judge by.<sup>15</sup> For a painting sold unframed, whose size is its single most consequential property after the image itself, this is the finding that matters most.

**Different images answer different questions.** Product-page guidance commonly separates a plain view, an in-scale view, a close-up of material and texture, and a view in use. For a painting those become: the front, a raking-light detail, the edge and back, and the work at true size on a wall.

**No auto-rotation, and real controls.** The W3C pattern for a carousel requires a stop control whenever slides rotate on their own, stops rotation on focus and hover, and prefers a tab-style picker when slides are chosen directly — which is what a thumbnail rail is.<sup>16</sup>

**Icons need words.** Only the house, the printer and the magnifying glass are close to universally recognised; everything else — a person, a bag, a heart — is ambiguous without a visible label, and a label shown only on hover does not exist on a phone.<sup>17</sup>

**Search should be as prominent as search is useful.** Where people browse visually — Baymard's examples are apparel and home décor, and art is the same kind of purchase — a small search control is right; dominant search fields belong to large catalogues bought by specification.<sup>18</sup>

**Urgency must be true.** EU law treats falsely claiming limited availability to rush a decision as unfair in all circumstances.<sup>19</sup> A unique work is available once, so a scarcity bar would not be false here — but the page already says *Unique work*, and a "Hurry" is pressure the brief rules out.

### 6.3 What is different here

A shop template assumes multiple units of many products, an account system and one checkout for everything in the cart. None of those is true of this site yet.

- **Every work is unique.** A quantity stepper has one legal value. "Only 1 left" is permanently true.
- **The catalogue is small.** Search earns its place only by finding what a visitor would actually type — a title, a medium, a year, a series — in either language, and nothing else.

<sup>15</sup>Baymard Institute, [Provide at least one "in scale" image](#).

<sup>16</sup>W3C, [ARIA Authoring Practices Guide: Carousel pattern](#).

<sup>17</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Icon usability](#).

<sup>18</sup>Baymard Institute, [E-commerce search field design and its implications](#).

<sup>19</sup>Directive 2005/29/EC, Annex I, point 7.

- **There is no server.** The site is static by design. Accounts need authentication, password recovery and storage of personal data — which makes Priscilla a data controller under both PIPL and GDPR (Section 4.3) for nothing the buying path requires. The payment provider already holds the buyer's record.
- **There is no multi-item checkout yet.** On the launch route each work has its own payment link, or is sold by enquiry. Whether a provider on either route can take several works in one hosted checkout is **not established** (Table 21).
- **A cart widens the overselling window.** Section 5.3 defends a unique work from being sold twice. A cart invites a buyer to believe a work is held while it sits there, and every layer of that defence has to re-check it.

## 6.4 The decisions

Table 17: The decisions of 17 September 2026

| #  | Decided                                                 | What it means                                                                                                                     |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D1 | <b>Search, account and cart</b> in the header now       | Each leads to a placeholder route that lands on the 404 until its page is built                                                   |
| D2 | <b>Detail, edge, back and video</b> views on every work | Placeholders until the photographs and video exist. The scale diagram stays beside the work rather than becoming a generated view |
| D3 | <b>Any number of works in one order</b>                 | Limited only by availability and by the payment route's largest single transaction                                                |
| D4 | <b>No search threshold</b>                              | Search appears regardless of catalogue size, provided the query and the searchable text are correctly scoped                      |
| D5 | <b>Video on work pages only</b>                         | Nowhere else on the site carries video                                                                                            |

## 6.5 What is built

Figure 8 shows the result on a desktop.

- **The shop bar.** Search, account and cart on every page, in both languages, as icons whose accessible names are the words (*Search, Account, Cart*; 搜索, 账户, 购物车). Each destination is a declared placeholder, and `check-links` fails the build if one ever resolves — so a page cannot be built without its placeholder being retired in the same

change. On a phone the masthead takes two rows: the short name, *Senso Comune*, with the three icons; then the sections and the language switch. Below 360 px the name is kept for screen readers and the mark alone leads home.

- **Icons only, at every width.** The research above favours visible words; the reference Priscilla chose shows icons alone, and that is what was built. Only the magnifying glass is close to universal. If the account or cart icon proves ambiguous in use, the labels are one CSS change away: the words are already in the markup.
- **A bilingual 404.** Every placeholder lands on it: both languages, no canonical, not indexed, not in the sitemap.
- **The five views.** Front, detail, edge, back and video on every work page, in a scroll-snap strip that swipes natively, with thumbnails always visible — a rail from 900 px, a row below that. It works with no script. A small script adds what links cannot: the current thumbnail marked for screen readers, no history entry per thumbnail, arrow keys, Home and End, and a video that pauses when it leaves the strip. Video is never preloaded and never plays by itself. Only the front view carries the painting between pages (Section 2.5).
- **Placeholders that step aside.** The image pipeline draws a labelled placeholder for each missing view at a sensible proportion; a real photograph replaces it on the next build and keeps its own proportions. A release leaves out any view without a photograph rather than showing its placeholder.

## 6.6 Still to build

Each item names the evidence that closes it; *done* means the check exists and passes, not that the page looks right. Sizes: S is under a day, M a few days, L a week or more.

### 6.6.1 The buy box and disclosures

- **Assurance from data, not copy.** Three lines under the action, each true and each already argued in this document: the worldwide 14-day return (Section 4.1); how the work is packed and insured (Section 3.2); and a link that estimates import duty for the buyer's country (Section 3.3) — which none of the reference shops offer, and which is the question an international buyer of a \$300 painting actually has.
- **Disclosures as native accordions:** Details, Shipping and packaging, Duty and import, Returns, Contact. No script, keyboard-operable, readable with styles off.
- **Payment methods from the active entity.** On the launch route that is PayPal, Alipay and WeChat Pay and *no card marks*. A card logo shown by a seller that cannot take cards is a misleading claim, so the list is generated, like the rest of the entity switch (Section 5.2).

- **Sharing that works in China.** The device's own share sheet where the browser has one, and *Copy link* everywhere — not Facebook, X and Pinterest buttons, all unreachable in mainland China. WeChat builds its own link card from the Open Graph tags the site already publishes.

Table 18: The buy box, item by item

| Work                                                    | Done when                                                                                     | Size |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Reorder the aside: price, action, assurance             | The price is still the boldest element                                                        | S    |
| Assurance lines generated from <code>seller.json</code> | No assurance string typed into a template                                                     | S    |
| Duty estimate linked by destination                     | Every destination in Table 12 reachable                                                       | M    |
| <details> disclosures                                   | Operable by keyboard; content present with styles off                                         | S    |
| Payment methods from the active entity                  | Built with <code>hk-sole-prop</code> , card marks appear; with <code>individual</code> , none | S    |
| Share sheet with copy-link fallback                     | Works with the API absent; no third-party share scripts                                       | S    |
| More works: three available, never sold                 | A sold work never appears                                                                     | S    |



### 6.6.2 Behind the shop bar

Each is specified in the README (*Scripting still needed*). Building one means removing its placeholder route from `site.json`, which the link check and the readiness gate both require.

Table 19: The cart, search and account

| Page    | Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Done when                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Size |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Cart    | Works gathered on the device; a total held under the entity's <code>maxTransactionUSD</code> ; <code>availability.json</code> re-checked on open and before paying; several works paid in one payment where the provider allows it, otherwise work by work | A sold work is never counted in a total; no single payment exceeds the ceiling; a work in two carts cannot be paid for twice; order confirmation and withdrawal information reviewed against Section 4.1 and Section 4.2 | L    |
| Search  | An index written by the build — title, medium, year and series, in both languages — searched in the browser, by substring so Chinese needs no word segmentation                                                                                            | English and Chinese queries both find titles and media; nothing outside the indexed fields matches                                                                                                                       | M    |
| Account | A server, a login, password recovery and a privacy regime, for an order history the payment provider already keeps                                                                                                                                         | Reasonable only if the site moves to a hosted commerce platform that supplies accounts; not scheduled                                                                                                                    | —    |

### 6.6.3 Considered, and not planned

Table 20: Reference features left out

| Feature                   | Status                    | Why                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A generated in-scale view | Optional                  | Not taken under D2; the scale diagram already does the job beside the work                                                          |
| Web AR on the wall        | Optional — <i>later</i>   | Native Android AR viewers rely on Google Play services, largely absent in mainland China; in-browser AR needs a commercial platform |
| Make an offer             | Optional                  | The enquiry already does this; a form needs a back end                                                                              |
| Quantity stepper          | Not recommended           | One legal value                                                                                                                     |
| "Hurry, only 1 left"      | Not recommended           | True, but pressure; <i>Unique work</i> already says it                                                                              |
| Instalment financing      | Not recommended           | Neither entity route has a lending partner                                                                                          |
| Review score              | Not recommended at launch | No reviews exist; inventing them is unlawful                                                                                        |

## PART 7

## Open items

Six places where the evidence is thinner than the decision resting on it. Every one needs a person outside this project — a customs broker, a tax adviser, a carrier, a payment provider — and none can be closed by writing more code.

Table 21: Unresolved, in rough order of cost if wrong

| # | Item                                                             | Status                                                               | What to do                                                                                              |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Cultural-relics export appraisal                                 | <b>Not established.</b> Chinese government sources unreachable       | Confirm a living artist's new work is not 文物 before the first export                                    |
| 2 | EU reduced art VAT rates                                         | <b>Unverified.</b> Directive (EU) 2022/542 changed art VAT from 2025 | Do not publish per-country rates yet                                                                    |
| 3 | Carrier costs and insurance from China                           | No verified figures                                                  | Needed before the shipping page is final                                                                |
| 4 | Export declaration for a \$300 painting                          | Not established                                                      | Also determines what supports the bank's FX check                                                       |
| 5 | Airwallex + HK sole proprietorship                               | Entity list verified for account opening only                        | Ask before incorporating                                                                                |
| 6 | Several works in one payment, and the largest single transaction | <b>Not established</b> on either route                               | Ask the provider in writing before the cart is built; the figure becomes <code>maxTransactionUSD</code> |

### 7.1 Settled in the build

Table 22: Questions the build answered, and where

| Item                        | Resolution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Where                                   |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| CJK webfont strategy        | The display face is subset to the characters that appear in headings, work titles and UI labels: <b>34 KB, from a 24 MB face.</b> <code>unicode-range</code> gates the fetch, so an English page never downloads it, and a character added before the next build falls through to the system face rather than rendering as tofu. Chinese body prose is deliberately not webfont-served. | <code>scripts/build-fonts-cjk.py</code> |
| Leonardo's hatching angle   | Recorded in the stylesheet as a measurement rather than a citation, with the caveat that two chalk sheets ran the other way                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <code>src/styles/base.css</code>        |
| Mona Lisa glaze layer count | The thickness is cited; the count is not, and the comment says why                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>      |
| A mark for two languages    | A mark that carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales, generated from a single geometry for the tab, the home screen, the masthead and this document                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <code>scripts/mark.mjs</code>           |

## 7.2 Content still outstanding

The 54 details in Section 5.5.4. The blocking ones that matter most are the photographs, the titles and descriptions, and the contact details — the email and phone are not optional; they are the consumer-law requirement in Section 4.2.

One design item is also still open. The Chinese-locale enquiry route should be WeChat rather than a `mailto:`, and that needs a QR image that does not exist yet.

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## Appendix: sources and method

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**Colour.** Ratios computed with the WCAG 2 relative-luminance formula. The draft's values were extracted from the PDF content stream rather than sampled from a render, so they are declared values. Figures in this document read the project's live token file.

**Fonts.** Built with fonttools 4.59.1 from the variable originals; byte counts are measured output, not estimates.

**Reachability from mainland China.** Measured against a GFW measurement service, with known-blocked controls validating the method before any result was accepted.

**Regulatory material.** Chinese provisions read from `gov.cn` and `safe.gov.cn`; EU instruments from the Publications Office; US tariff treatment from the HTSUS and the Federal Register. Article numbers are given so each can be checked.

**Layout.** Verified in headless Chrome at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px, not by description; phone widths are laid out in an iframe of the stated width, because Chrome will not lay a window out below 500 px (Section 5.4). The captures in Section 2.8 are taken from `dist/` by `docs/report/shots.sh` as part of this document's build, so they cannot show a version of the site that is no longer shipping.

**The mark.** Figure 3 and the mark in this document's footer are both drawn from `mark.mjs`, the one file the site's icons and its masthead are generated from. The TikZ copy of those numbers in the preamble is checked against it on every build. The hanging figure of 144.78 cm is the museum standard already used by the scale diagram on every work page.

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